

Round Structure

The game lasts 15 rounds across three Seasons. Each round follows the same four phases.

Season	Rounds	Focus
Season I - Foundations	1-5	Resource production, early routes, and starting infrastructure
Season II - Growth	6-10	Population, Arrivals, travel expansion, industry, and community development
Season III - Maturity	11-15	Resilience, Renown, final refinement, and unresolved settlement pressure
Phase	Name	Summary
1	Seed Encounter Cards	Each player with cards remaining in hand seeds 1 hidden Encounter Card anywhere into the Encounter Deck.
2	Reveal Encounters	Reveal standard Encounter Cards from the top of the Encounter Deck equal to player count. Golden Boons are extra reveals.
3	Player Turns	Each player takes one turn with 4 Actions. The group chooses turn order.
4	End of Round	Remove Arrival timers, expire failed Arrivals, discard applicable Boons, and advance the Round Timer.

Reveal And Actions By Player Count

Player Count	Standard Encounter Cards Revealed per Round	Actions per Player
1	1	4
2	2	4
3	3	4
4	4	4

Player Actions

Action	Summary
Place a Tile	Place an available tile into an empty legal map space.
Upgrade a Tile	Flip a placed basic tile to its upgraded side.
Activate a Tile	Use a tile with an Activated Effect, including Resource Tile Production.
Interact with an Encounter Card	Complete an Arrival or resolve/interact with an active Burden on the Stewards Board.
Travel to a Disconnected Tile	Move beyond the connected settlement network, including unbridged river crossing or disconnected placement.

Players may also spend extra Actions when a tile action requires disconnected Travel or river crossing. The prototype calculates these costs, but players should still understand why they happened.